

Identity & Access Management (IAM)

Comprehensive Domain Resource & Learning Guide

1. Modern Protocols: OAuth 2.0 & OIDC

The industry standard for secure delegation and identity verification in web applications. OAuth 2.0 handles *what* you can do (Authorization), while OIDC handles *who* you are (Authentication).

Type	Resource Title & Link	Key Takeaway
VIDEO	OAuth 2.0 and OpenID Connect in Plain English	The gold standard introduction to the conceptual flow of tokens and scopes.
ARTICLE	OAuth 2.0 Simplified	A definitive guide to the different "Grant Types" and when to use each.
BLOG	The Difference Between OIDC and OAuth 2.0	A practical breakdown of why OIDC was created as a layer on top of OAuth.

2. Enterprise Protocols: SAML 2.0 & SCIM

Foundational protocols for corporate environments. SAML is the backbone of traditional Single Sign-On (SSO), and SCIM automates user provisioning across systems.

Type	Resource Title & Link	Key Takeaway
ARTICLE	The Illustrated Guide to SAML	Visually explains XML assertions and the dance between Identity Providers (IdP) and Service Providers (SP).
BLOG	SAML vs. OAuth: Which one should I use?	Compares legacy enterprise needs vs. modern mobile/web needs.
DOC	What is SCIM? (Provisioning)	Explains how to automate the lifecycle of a user account across multiple cloud apps.

3. Microsoft Identity Ecosystem

Specific focus on Active Directory (on-prem) and Microsoft Entra ID (cloud), and the tools developers use to interact with them.

Type	Resource Title & Link	Key Takeaway
VIDEO	What is Microsoft Entra ID?	High-level overview of Microsoft's cloud identity platform.
DOC	Microsoft Identity Platform Basics	Detailed documentation on implementing OIDC in the Microsoft stack.
ARTICLE	Entra ID Architecture Fundamentals	Deep dive into the infrastructure of global identity management.

4. Architecture: Zero Trust & Governance

The strategic side of IAM. How to design systems that assume the network is already compromised and grant access with the "Principle of Least Privilege."

Type	Resource Title & Link	Key Takeaway
DOC	NIST SP 800-207: Zero Trust Architecture	The foundational PDF whitepaper defining the Zero Trust standard for the industry.
ARTICLE	RBAC vs. ABAC (NIST Perspective)	Technical comparison between role-based and attribute-based security models.
BLOG	The Principle of Least Privilege (PoLP)	Fundamental security concept: why users should only have the minimum access necessary.

5. Operational IAM: PAM & JML Lifecycle

The business logic of identity. Managing highly sensitive "Superuser" accounts and the automated lifecycle of employees from hire to fire.

Type	Resource Title & Link	Key Takeaway
VIDEO	What is Privileged Access Management (PAM)?	Overview of vaulting, rotation, and session monitoring for admin accounts.
ARTICLE	Automating the JML Lifecycle	Explains how enterprises handle hiring (Joiner), transfers (Mover), and departures (Leaver).
BLOG	The Dangers of 'Access Creep'	Critical look at why the "Mover" phase of JML is often the biggest security risk.